



**MEDFORD, MASSACHUSETTS
MAYOR BREANNA LUNGO-KOEHN**

June 18, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery

To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
85 George P. Hassett Drive
Medford, MA 02155

**Re: Main Street Corridor – Order to Acquire Easements, Order of Taking and
Order of Alteration of Layout**

Dear President Bears and City Councilors:

As you are aware, the City is working in coordination with MassDOT to construct traffic and safety improvements to the Main Street corridor, beginning just south of Thomas St. and extending just north of the westbound Mystic Valley Parkway (Route 16) on- and off-ramps. The work area also extends on Mystic Ave (Route 38) from Main St. to just beyond Union St. The project will add traffic signals to three major intersections and include roadway mill and overlay, intersection geometry revisions, and improvements to sidewalks, bus lanes, bicycle lanes, crosswalks, signage, and pavement markings.

The federal funding granted for this project requires that the right-of-way be in complete ownership and physical control of the City. A survey prepared for the project identified nine (9) private properties that contain public infrastructure. The City needs to acquire permanent and temporary easements as part of the project to facilitate the reconstructions of sidewalks, driveway entrances, and relocating overhead wires. The project also requires the City to alter the layouts of Main Street and Mystic Avenue to include within said layouts the public infrastructure on private properties. The layout alterations have been approved by the Mayor and by the Community Development Board.

Enclosed are the following documents for your consideration: a City Council Order to acquire the easements; the Order of Taking, to take the easements by eminent domain; an Order of Alteration of Layout to alter the layout of Main Street and Mystic Avenue; the Alteration Plan; and the recommendation of the Community Development Board.

The easements were appraised by a certified General Appraiser, and those appraisals were reviewed by a certified General Review Appraiser to establish just compensation for the easements. Written offers were sent to all nine (9) property owners via certified mail on May 6, 2026. Assistant City Engineer Sierra Schatz has been in contact with each owner to answer



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questions and address concerns throughout this process beginning with the initial contact letter sent in February 2026.

I respectfully request that the City Council vote to adopt the Order approving the acquisition of the easements and to execute the Order of Taking, effectuating the acquisition, and the Order of Alteration of Layouts at your regular June 23, 2026 meeting.

Assistant City Engineer Sierra Schatz will be in attendance to answer questions on this matter.

Thank you for your kind attention to this matter.

Sincerely,


Breanna Lungo-Koehn
Mayor

Enclosures